

~THE_STACKER_MUSE

<3 your creative
writing



P2P Marketplace
it's like Craigslist,
but we trade with *bitcoin*.

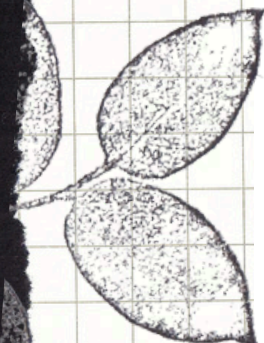


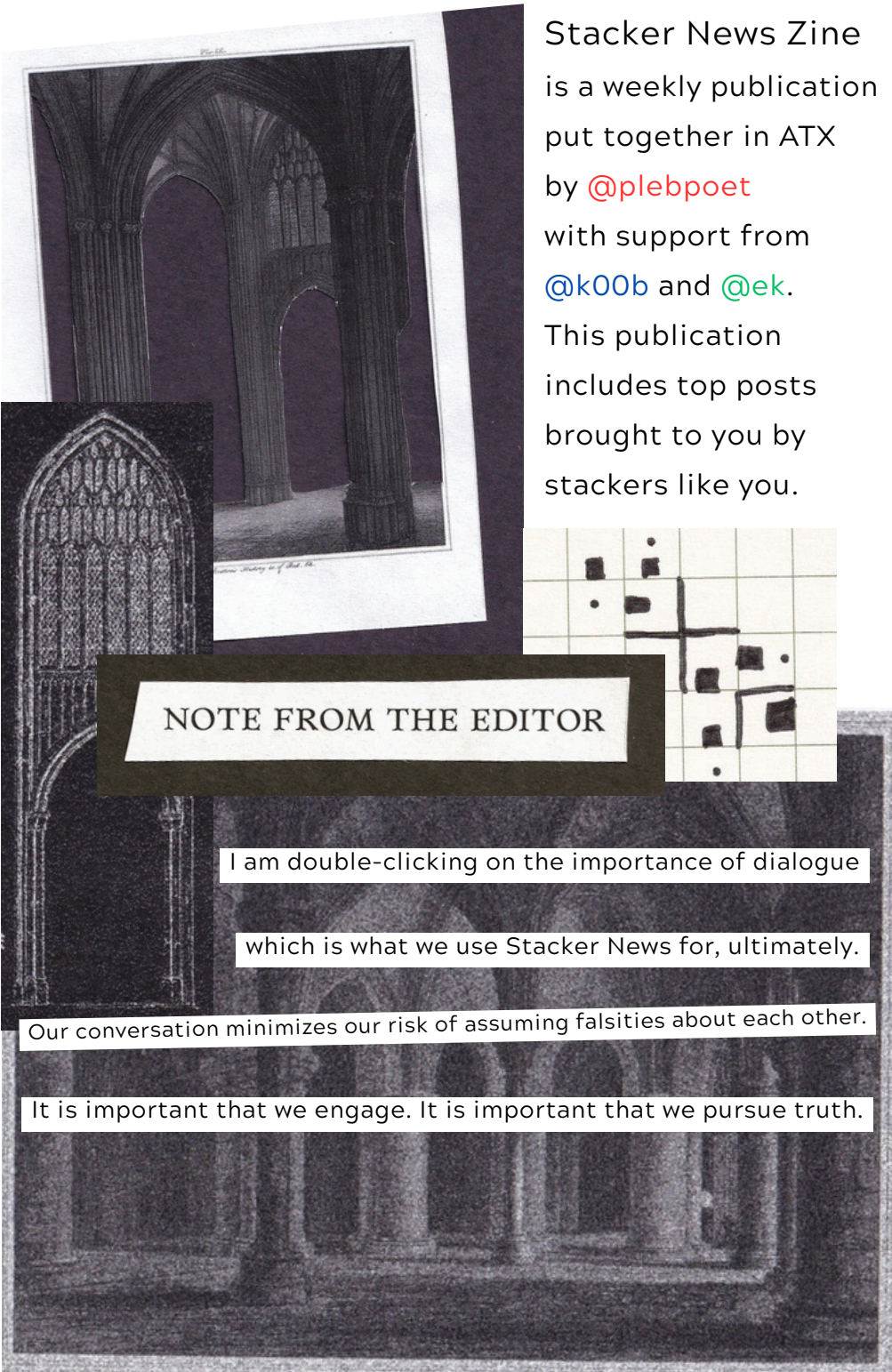
- @SimpleStacker
Block Height 913459

Rest in Peace,
Charlie Kirk

SNZ #CLASSIFIEDS

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Stacker News Zine
is a weekly publication
put together in ATX
by [@plebpoet](#)
with support from
[@k00b](#) and [@ek](#).
This publication
includes top posts
brought to you by
stackers like you.

NOTE FROM THE EDITOR

I am double-clicking on the importance of dialogue

which is what we use Stacker News for, ultimately.

Our conversation minimizes our risk of assuming falsities about each other.

It is important that we engage. It is important that we pursue truth.

FROM THIS WEEK

Trump ally Charlie Kirk reported shot



at Utah college event

2223 sats \ 87 comments \ [@siggy47](#)
10 Sep Politics_And_Law

Is It Wrong To Be Divisive?

1563 sats \ 6 comments \ [@kepford](#)
Sep 11 Politics_And_Law



I'm Andreas Griffin, creator of Bitcoin



Safe, AMA!

4887 sats \ 41 comments \
[@Andreasgriffin](#) 10 Sep AMA

Does Bitcoin have a constitution?

11.4k sats \ 27 comments \ [@Scoresby](#)
5 Sep bitcoin



Knots doesn't make any sense to me



4105 sats \ 57 comments \
[@028559d218](#) 7 Sep bitcoin

Clairo - Bags - Recorded At
Electric Lady Studios

241 sats \ 10k boost \ 2 comments \ [@ek](#) 9 Sep Music



My favorite Clairo song! I'm
learning it on piano, hopefully I
can share a recording soon

Also cool interview
about it here:



TOP POST

Why do you use SN? and other questions

2167 sats \ 54 comments \ @SimpleStacker 7 Sep AskSN



- What brought you to SN in the first place?
- What brings you back to SN?
- What causes you to make posts on SN?

STACKERS RESPOND THUS:

219 sats \ 2 replies \ @Undisciplined 7 Sep

An ad on Fountain describing SN as Reddit, but with real money in place of cheap likes. I was in the process of finding alternatives to Big Tech platforms, particularly those that used real transferrable tokens (not a bitcoiner yet) to reward engagement.

I was hooked almost immediately. Being new to bitcoin (and crypto), I mostly read and asked questions. On posts related to politics, economics, or science (which were less common before territories), I'd engage more in the discussions.

The quality of discussion is completely unrivalled and that's what I wanted from social media. I also love getting to talk to the devs about the structure of the site.

Now, of course, I also check in regularly to keep tabs on my territories.

Usually, I just want to share stuff with the other stackers and see what they think about it.

I also make some posts that I think of more as territory maintenance.
reply

245 sats \ 2 replies \ @k00b 7 Sep

... I think something like SN, the way it solves problems, is the future of the internet. . .

270 sats \ 2 replies \ @optimism 7 Sep

People linking interesting posts on nostr (maybe X initially). I lurked (on and off) for almost 2 years before creating an acct.

Stackers, because awesome.

For ~AI, I try to post about developments that haven't been posted by others yet and I like doing the weekly summaries. For everything else, I try to share not-yet-on-SN great or remarkable content.

1397 sats \ 2 replies \ @Scoresby 7 Sep

I was just looking for a place to talk about bitcoin. Reddit kept banning me and Twitter felt like I could never join the conversation.

For a long time it was just the sats. I really really like getting zapped. Also, I was learning a lot about bitcoin with people who wanted to explore it beyond just 21 million + hold your own keys. Still am.

Now, I think I'm mostly motivated by trying to write something new about bitcoin. I post a lot of stuff I think people will find interesting, but I really put a lot of time into original posts, trying to find some new angle or facts about bitcoin.

234 sats \ 0 replies \ @SimpleStacker OP 7 Sep

I was fairly active on r/bitcoin and someone posted a link to SN. I checked it out and found the conversations deeper and more interesting than Reddit. For a while, I was active on both, but r/bitcoin started getting authoritarian (they'd censor posts about shitcoins... I don't agree with censorship and I much prefer the no-censorship but get a lashing from Darth method of SN...)

It's a variety of things. Obviously, the mix of topics is right up my alley: bitcoin, economics, technology, libertarianism. But the quality of the engagement is also higher than most other places, afaict

I usually post when I think I have something interesting to share. If it's a longer thought piece, I make a post. If it's a short snippet of a thought, I tend to post in Saloon.

Getting zapped for a post is definitely nice, and so is getting engagement. Zaps and engagement are what drives continued participation, imo.

140 sats \ 1 reply \ @cryotosensei 7 Sep

I like that I understand more about the world, thanks to the different perspectives and lived experiences from Stackers. It makes my pedestrian life a bit more exciting and meaningful haha. I never cease to be amazed at how different Stackers come to similar conclusions about life based on their different paths. This universality to me is mind-boggling and attractive.

I am motivated to post here as a result of different motivations: to declutter my papers and photos (using SN as a repository of my experiences)

as a journal (to not let the daily moments slip by)

as a sounding board (I don't mind unburdening myself in front of friends and making myself vulnerable, but it isn't always the case that my friends can be there for me when I most need a listening ear. I find that SN fulfills my need to be seen and heard in those pivotal moments)



TOP POST

Stacker News Fiction Month Grand Prize Winner

2099 sats \ 30 comments \ [@Scoresby](#) 8 Sep BooksAndArticles

The judges for the 2025 edition of Stacker News Fiction Month are pleased to announce that [@billytheked](#) is the grand prize winner for his submission "Sagas of the Lincoln County War."

There were so many good entries in Fiction Month that making this decision was quite difficult. We each enjoyed different stories; however, all three of us agreed that [Sagas of the Lincoln County War](#) was something special.



[@billytheked](#) set a detailed scene that pulled us into the story and left us standing in a world we could almost touch. Curious, feeling at times like an old timey daguerreotype and at others like a travelogue, billytheked delivered an excellent story which we all hope he will continue.

The Prize

[@billytheked](#): please post a lightning invoice for 100k sats and I will pay it.

Additionally, 21Futures would like to publish this story on their website, [21futures.com](#)



238 sats \ 9 replies \ [@billytheked](#) 8 Sep
verily --what an honor 'twas to have the story judged alongside all the others in this contest --reading some of the other great works --the speculative/science fiction --mystery --and others that elude genre --i felt my work may have been in the wrong contest --also seeing as it is not a bitcoin story i feel doubly honored that the judges would say such nice things about it --hopefully the sagas valorized the frontier outlaw not to admonish his rancour --drunkenness or violence --but because in him (and her) lives the spirit of the american frontier --the spirit that inspires the adventure to do what we believe is right even at the cost of transgressing those (cronies) occupying conventional seats of power --a spirit i believe to be alive in the bitcoiners of today
BIG THANK YOU TO [@siggy47](#) [@TotallyHumanWriter](#) and [@Scoresby](#) for organizing this contest and the countless other writers that made it so interesting --lastly thank you to my mammy for raising me good and
YUH BETTER SLEEP WITH ONE EYE OPEN PAT GARRETT I'M COMING FOR YUH



TOP POST

Murch and Chris have a conversation - What is Going on Here???

2382 sats \ 51 comments \ @028559d218 8 Sep bitcoin
zaps forwarded to @fourrules (1%) @Murch (20%)



There is an xcancel thread I have been reading, it's a long one and I don't know why some of these issues haven't been better discussed (at least to the best of my knowledge.)

Doesn't it relate intimately to the conversations around "data"... and Knots and "spam mitigation???"

The conversation is between @Murch and Chris Guida (who's not on Stacker News?). I have tried to post the xcancel links here... it's not easy but I will do my best with links and screenshots as there are some fundamental questions... I wish I had answered.

Because space is scarce even in this zine,
only the main points are reproduced from this article.
Use the QR code above to follow the conversation in full.

1. First of all, there is a fundamental disagreement as to whether or not Bitcoin transactions of a "monetary" purpose can outbid those of a speculative or "arbitrary-data" origin.
2. Then the conversation shifts to the nature and reasons for the bloat of the UTXO set. How did the UTXO set get bloated and why???
3. The conversation then briefly turns to the economics of consolidating the "dust" from BRC20s... where the AI bot says that such dust never gets consolidated because it's "irrational to ever spend them."
4. Finally... the conversation turns to what to do about "UTXO bloat" in the future?

DISCUSSION

456 sats \ 0 replies \ @Murch fwd 8 Sep

The "special thing" about Runes is that they do exactly what BRC20 was doing (defining, minting, and transferring tokens), but it does so in OP_RETURN outputs, which do not get added to the UTXO set, in a blockspace efficient manner. So, it's simply better in all dimensions than BRC20 tokens at what BRC20 tokens supposedly do, without resulting in an incentive to create minuscule abandoned outputs. And it was created by the inventor of Ordinals which probably makes it even more blessed in some circles. :shrug:

500 sats \ 39 replies \ @Scoresby 8 Sep

< How the hell are filters supposed to work??? Aren't people supposed to WANT Bitcoin and WANT to transact with it? How do you "filter" out something with 1000x greater demand that people want to USE?

I've never understood this about Guida's argument: if a lot of people want to use the chain for data, how does filtering stop it?

< After all, what prevents a GOVERNMENT from attacking Bitcoin by spending a relatively modest amount of money, taking Bitcoin and "dividing it up" into millions of UTXOs for which only THEY have the keys?

Even more agree with you here.

The anti-spam crowd says there are valid transactions that can harm bitcoin and potentially even pose an existential threat to it. If this is true, why wouldn't a state use such transactions to attack bitcoin?

If a state does, do we believe filters will be able to stop them?

If the answer is no -> then anything that can get to the chain can (and probably will) be used as an attack. If there are valid transactions that can threaten the viability of Bitcoin, this is a major problem that we probably ought to address with a consensus change. If the answer is yes -> what do we even need mining for? If filters can stop state actors from confirming valid chains, why wouldn't state actors use filters themselves to prevent us from sending "illegal" transactions?

The whole thing is nonsensical to me.

Either you think the spam transactions are a real problem and you propose a consensus change or you think they are not a serious problem.

TOP POST



Gold was used for persistent data storage too
4693 sats \ 32 comments \ @SimpleStacker 8 Sep bitcoin

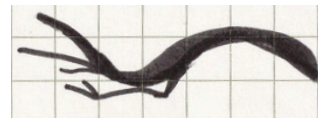
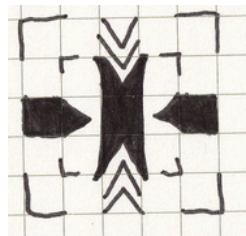
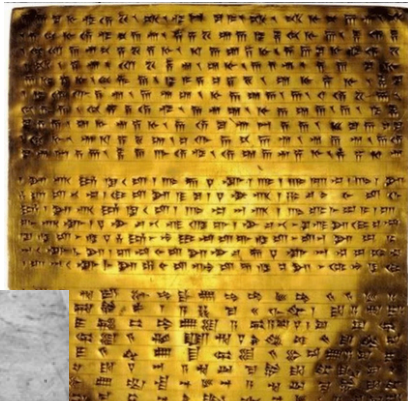
Bitcoin is money. But Bitcoin is also decentralized, persistent data storage. The current debate between Core and Knots is about the extent to which we should try to prevent using Bitcoin for data storage. Core's position seems to be that it's inevitable, and we should try to minimize the damages. Knot's position seems to be that we should do more to fight arbitrary data on Bitcoin.

There are many debates about this raging on the internet, including here on SN.

As I thought about this, I thought back to the analogy between gold and Bitcoin. "Bitcoin is digital gold," is how it's often described. Then I thought about all the ways gold was used, and it struck me that people have used gold for both monetary exchange and data storage / artistic expression since the dawn of human history.

For example, this image shows a gold tablet from Ancient Persia bearing an inscription about the rule of King Darius:

source: https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Apadana_hoard



TOP POST

People used gold to make statues and inscriptions because of gold's properties: it is one of the least reactive metals, and thus will persist over time.

So with that insight, should we not expect that people will want to use Bitcoin for artistic expression and data storage? The very properties that make gold and Bitcoin good money: immutable, persistent, etc, also make it highly sought after as a medium for data.

So if gold could, for millennia, simultaneously be used for monetary exchange and data storage, can't we expect the same of Bitcoin?



CONTESTS

**MEME MONDAY -
BEST BITCOIN MEME
GETS 5,000 CCS**

393 sats \ 30 comments \ [@sn](#) 8 Sep memes

5121 sats \ 0 replies \ [@Jon_Hodl](#) 8 Sep

**ME DESTROYING THE
LEGACY FINANCIAL SYSTEM**

**THE STORY I WILL
TELL MY GRANDCHILDREN**



**'TASTE OF ABSURDITIES'
(VOLUME 1)**

- PHOTOZINE

1387 sats \ 2 comments \
[@PictureRoom](#) 8 Sep art



**TASTES OF
ABSURDITIES
VOLUME
#1**
BY:
OWEN MADIGAN &
COLIN CZERWINSKI



GAMES

find the words - earn the prize*

Y V S F	Absurd	P G C N
Y J E S B	Legacy	H V U R X
H O R I M W	Server	H X P W V H
L M V X R I R		L U R K E R V
D E X D X S M		C L E F N F V
R X D E L P O		D H L C P O K
C G K N P K D G I R I O A P		
D H T F E J O K I N F V		
A B S U R D W S C Z		
D P Q M S B N O		
V C W Y B I Y L		
B E P C Z M I S N O		
N E P A U J Z D Q T E A		
Z F X G X A U H E P L E G D		
V W W E P Q V		U B J B N C D
M G T L C T W		M R F R T D L
G U D K P G V		P Z G W L A S
R R W W F W	Murch	R M C P Y I
K C E J B	Chris	U Z H K F
Z H L C		D E A A

Download
Persistent

Lincoln
Lurker

*the prize is sats. Tag [@plebpoet](#) when you complete the puzzle

Answers

Last week's cross word answers:

1. stacker
2. sync
3. wasabi
4. privacy
5. lightning
6. routing
7. fiction
8. college
9. anon
10. zap
11. pleb
12. meme

GAMES

A PSA from Nicolas Dorier for those who run a BTCPay Server on a VPS

1002 sats \ 5 comments \ @DarthCoin 9 Sep bitcoin



Read the whole thread on Twix source:
<https://xcancel.com/NicolasDorier/status/1963873106453512352>

Retweeting this, and also explaining the direct impact on @BtcPayServer. (But first, read Antoine's post with a cool head, even if you dislike him.)



TL;DR: Most deployed BTCPay Servers will, sooner or later, be bricked. The change to the OP_RETURN size limit may prevent this. Here's why. When I created BTCPay Server, a hard requirement was keeping costs as low as possible and do not require our users to use command line. That's why we love Bitcoin: everyone can verify. The most popular option was (and still is) to buy a server on LunaNode. You could host BTCPay for \$7 per month (M2 instance). It comes with a 20GB SSD.

How we kept server costs low

To keep costs down, blocks are stored on a separate volume of ~80GB. Our default deployment runs in pruned mode. This means blocks are downloaded, verified, stored temporarily, and discarded over time. As a result, the volume size is always sufficient. Bitcoin doesn't only store blocks; it also stores the current state (the UTXO set), which requires high throughput. Because of this, unlike the blocks, it isn't stored on the separate volume but on the main drive (20GB).

The UTXO set size had always been relatively stable at the time, so 20GB was considered enough to keep costs low. Up to 2022, the UTXO set was about 4GB. Now, it's around 12GB, almost entirely due to spam. Uh oh.

This means very old BTCPay Servers on M2 instances will soon be bricked (since the 20GB must also hold the OS). If you create a new server on LunaNode today, the default is now M4 (twice as expensive, \$14 per month).

If your server is still running on M2, I strongly advise upgrading ASAP. Once the storage runs out, your server won't be able to restart. Upgrading after that point may or may not go smoothly. Regardless of all of above, M4 is recommended as it also improves stability.

The problem of unbounded storage growth

If the UTXO set keeps growing forever, it's a big problem. You couldn't just set up BTCPay Server and forget about it; you'd need to monitor storage and upgrade your machine periodically. That's a high technical barrier for most merchants.

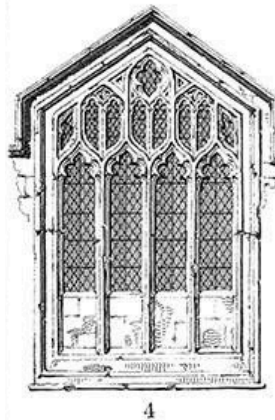
As Antoine points out, the specific spam has two approaches: one using unspendable outputs, and the other using OP_RETURN.

The nice thing about OP_RETURN is that it's only stored in blocks, which means your node can safely discard it. Thanks to this, the UTXO set growth can stay stable, or even shrink.

The problem of fast sync

Another issue with a larger UTXO set is fast sync. Setting up a new BTCPay Server could once be accelerated by downloading 4GB of data instead of the entire blockchain.

Now it's 12GB. As a result, we've reduced the frequency of fast sync snapshot updates for BTCPay Server.



This makes bootstrapping a server way slower. I know all of this doesn't cover all your grievances on Core (why don't they just keep the knobs?).

I know that there exists way to make the problem of the UTXO Set size go away. (why don't they just implement Utreexo, X/Y/Z?)

But suffice to say that those solutions are far from ready, and wouldn't depend solely on Core to work in practice.

